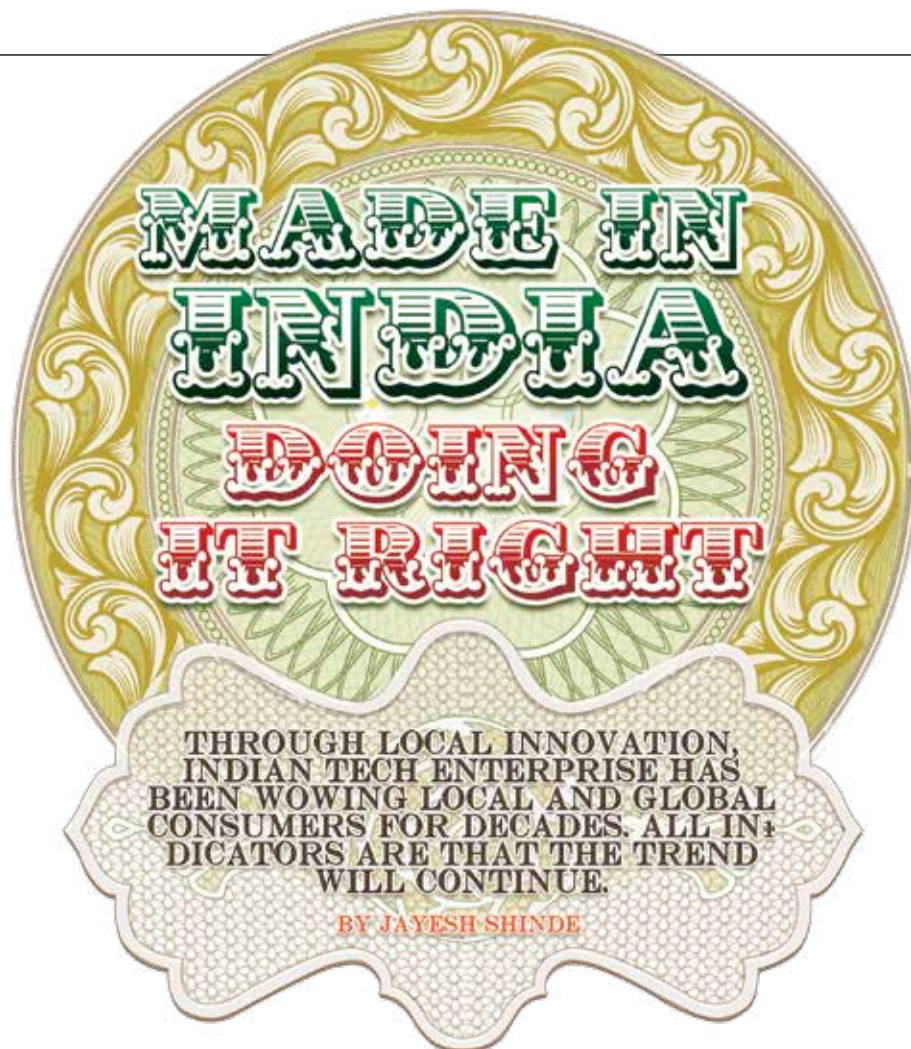




India always had a semblance of local manufacturing serving local consumers. Sure, it was never a world beater in manufacturing, but it wasn't embarrassingly bad either. Things changed in the mid-90s after India opened its markets for the world to sell its goods in, leading to increased competition between local and foreign brands. We, the consumers, benefited.

Headquartered in Amsterdam, Philips incorporated its local presence as Philips India as far back as 1930. Almost 50 years later, when almost every other MNC exited the country, Philips India bit the bullet and stuck on. They quickly realised that to be successful in India they had to set up local manufacturing units.

Philips adapted to India's needs and quickly became a force to be reckoned with. With its sodium vapor lights, Philips first transformed India's streetlights; then it was colour TVs and CFL bulbs. The result? More than 60 percent of its revenue comes from locally manufactured products, according to Priyank Agarwal, Head, Strategy & Business Development, Philips India.

It doesn't just stop there. Restricting ourselves just to the technology vertical, companies such as Godrej, Videocon, NIIT, Justdial, TCS, Wipro, Infosys, InMobi, Snapdeal, Karbonn Mobiles, Celkon, and a few others, are important and inspirational success stories.

Surely we must be doing something right for so many to have Made in India long before it was a political slogan? Without further ado, let's celebrate some Made in India success stories.

CELEBRATING INDIAN MAKE

At the height of the dotcom boom, when the first few Indians started enjoying dial-up Internet through VSNL, Bhavin Turakhia started Directi in 1998 with the help of his brother - Directi provides domain name registration and online web hosting.

When asked about the importance of technology in all the companies he founded, Bhavin said, "Technology played a major part in the development of Directi as a company, and in turn in our fortunes. Because we hire some of the smartest people in the technology space, we were able to leverage

the collective acumen to build on existing technologies, to create platforms and systems that would set up each of our business units for success. Even today, technology drives our success at Directi."

Headquartered in Mumbai and more than three decades old, Videocon is a leading consumer electronics and home appliances brand in the country with over 180 million customers.

"From inspiration to purchase, technology plays an integral role in crafting not only the product but also the consumer experience. After the launch and encouraging response for our feature packed 4K TV series last year, and the revolutionary Videocon Wi-Fi AC and Quantum Edge Technology AC this year, it's obvious that technology is the prior focus for Videocon customers," says Akshay Dhoot, Videocon's Chief of Technology and Innovation.

NEW KIDS ON THE BLOCK

Even in the fast-paced smartphone market, Indian companies who manufacture their handsets in India have found a lot of success, proving to be a fine example of why